



# GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

*Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church*

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

JUNE/JULY

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*Good Things Happen*  
is the newsletter of  
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,  
published each month.

**The deadline for August is July 15**

Contributions may be brought to the  
office or emailed to  
[office@minnehaha.org](mailto:office@minnehaha.org)  
**3701 East 50th Street**  
**Minneapolis, MN 55417**  
**Phone: 612/721-6231**

### About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

### A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

### Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

# June & July



### SUMMER SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:30 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

# Minnehaha Happenings in June & July

| Sun                                                                                                                      | Mon                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Tue                                                                                                                                                                               | Wed                                                                                                               | Thu                                                                                      | Fri                                                                                                  | Sat                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>1 JUNE</b><br>4p Methodicals<br>7p Children's Council                                                          | <b>2</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>6p M&ala Graduation                                          | <b>3</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA                                                                 | <b>4</b>                                                                   |
| <b>5 Communion</b><br>Graduation Sunday<br>10a Worship<br>6:30p Togo Church<br>7p SAA                                    | <b>6</b><br>10a Boyt Memorial<br>10a OA<br>6:30p Finance<br>6:30p Boy Scouts<br>6:30p UMW Lead.                                                                                                                                                              | <b>7</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>10:30a Food Shelf<br>12p Music Lesson<br>6:30p Toastmasters                                                                                           | <b>8</b><br>10a Staff Meeting<br>11a UMW Picnic<br>4p Methodicals<br>5:30p Brighter Minds                         | <b>9</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>1p Communion @<br>Nokomis Sq<br>6p Evening Circles<br>Dinner | <b>10</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA                                                                | <b>11</b><br>1:30p Girl Scouts                                             |
| <b>12</b><br>9a Indoor Worship<br>10:30a Outdoor Wor-<br>ship<br>6:30p Venturing Crew<br>7p SAA                          | <b>13</b><br><b>Music &amp; Dr. Camp</b><br>10a OA<br>6:30p Boy Scouts                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>14 Flag Day</b><br><b>Music &amp; Dr. Camp</b><br>West Heights Y. Gr.<br>9a Fun & Fit<br>10:30a Food Shelf<br>12p Music Lesson<br>5p Dinner<br>6p Worship<br>7p Church Council | <b>15</b><br><b>Music &amp; Dr. Camp</b><br><i>Vacation Bible School</i><br>West Heights Y. Gr.<br>4p Methodicals | <b>16</b><br><b>Music &amp; Dr. Camp</b><br><i>Vacation Bible School</i><br>9a Fun & Fit | <b>17</b><br><b>Music &amp; Dr. Camp</b><br><i>Vacation Bible School</i><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA | <b>18 International Picnic Day</b><br>8a Rummage Sale<br>1p IAM Meditation |
| <b>19 Father's Day</b><br>9a Indoor Worship<br>10:30a Outdoor Wor-<br>ship<br>6:30p Togo Church<br>7p SAA                | <b>20 Summer Solstice</b><br><b>Office Closed</b><br>10a OA<br>6:30p Boy Scouts<br>6:30p Wn's Soul Gr.                                                                                                                                                       | <b>21</b><br><b>Office Closed</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>10:30a Food Shelf<br>12p Music Lesson<br>6:30p Toastmasters                                                                  | <b>22</b><br><b>Office Closed</b><br>4p Methodicals                                                               | <b>23</b><br><b>Office Closed</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>6:30p Trustees & B+G                | <b>24</b><br><b>Office Closed</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA                                        | <b>25</b><br>7a MinneHarvest                                               |
| <b>26</b><br>9a Indoor Worship<br>10:30a Outdoor Wor-<br>ship<br>6:30p Vent.Crew<br>7p SAA                               | <b>27</b><br>10a OA<br>6:30p Boy Scouts                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>28</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>10:30a Food Shelf<br>12p Music Lesson<br>7p SPR                                                                                                      | <b>29</b><br>4p Methodicals<br>5:30p Brighter Minds                                                               | <b>30</b><br>9a Fun & Fit                                                                | <b>1 JULY</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA                                                            | <b>2</b><br>6a Joy Catering                                                |
| <b>3 Communion</b><br>6a Joy Catering<br>9a Indoor Worship<br>10:30a Outdoor Wor-<br>ship<br>6:30p Togo Church<br>7p SAA | <b>4 Independence Day</b><br>10a OA<br>6:30p Boy Scouts<br>6:30p UMW Lead.                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>5</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>10:30a Food Shelf<br>12p Music Lesson<br>6:30p Toastmasters                                                                                           | <b>6</b><br>4p Methodicals<br>5:30p Brighter Minds<br>7p Children's Council                                       | <b>7</b><br>9a Fun & Fit                                                                 | <b>8</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA                                                                 | <b>9</b><br>1:30p Girl Scouts                                              |
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| <b>17</b><br>9a Indoor Worship<br>10:30a Outdoor Wor-<br>ship<br>6p Venturing crew<br>6:30p Togo Church<br>7p SAA        | <b>18</b><br>10a OA<br>6:30p Boy Scouts<br>6:30p Wn's Soul Gr.                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>19</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>10:30a Food Shelf<br>12p Music Lesson<br>6:30p Toastmasters<br>6:30p Worship Commit-<br>tee                                                          | <b>20</b><br>4p Methodicals                                                                                       | <b>21</b><br>9a Fun & Fit                                                                | <b>22</b><br>9a <i>Newsletter Collation</i><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA                              | <b>23</b><br>7a MinneHarvest                                               |
| <b>24</b><br>9a Indoor Worship<br>10:30a Outdoor Wor-<br>ship<br>7p SAA                                                  | <b>25</b><br><b>Confirm. Camp</b><br>10a OA<br>6:30p Boy Scouts                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>26</b><br><b>Confirm. Camp</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>10:30a Food Shelf<br>12p Music Lesson<br>7p SPR                                                                              | <b>27</b><br><b>Confirm. Camp</b><br>4p Methodicals                                                               | <b>28</b><br><b>Confirm. Camp</b><br>9a Fun & Fit<br>6:30p Trustees & B+G                | <b>29</b><br><b>Confirm. Camp</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>6:30p RCA                                        | <b>30</b>                                                                  |
| <b>31</b><br>9a Indoor Worship<br>10:30a Outdoor Wor-<br>ship<br>6:30p Togo Church<br>7p SAA                             | <b>Notes:</b><br><b>Brighter Minds Music schedule was not available at time of printing. Please check the online calendar for updated times.</b><br><br><b>To avoid conflicts, please contact Heather in the office before scheduling events. Thank you!</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                   |                                                                                          |                                                                                                      |                                                                            |

## ***Worship in June and July***

We begin our summer schedule on June 12 with worship at 9:00 indoors and at 10:30 outdoors. If the weather requires us to go inside, we'll gather down in the Fellowship Hall (the band needs to begin setting up before the first service ends). We'll be walking with Jesus through the gospel of Luke this summer, hearing his teachings, watching him heal and cast out demons, and exploring that these ancient actions have to say to us in our current context. August 7 will be our annual ecumenical worship service at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30.

### ***June***

5th     **“Really?”**     Luke 7:11-17

*One Service at 10:00 a.m. Communion, Baccalaureate Sunday*

12th    **“Radically Forgiving Sins”**     Luke 7:36-8:3

*Kick off for VBS;*

*Summer Schedule begins, 9:00 indoors, 10:30 outside.*

19th    **“Healed”**     Luke 8:26-39

26th    **“Following”**     Luke 9:51-62

### ***July***

3rd     **“Doing”**     Luke 10:1-11, 16-20

*Communion*

10th    9:00 TBA

*10:30 Cowboy Church*

17th    **“Mary or Martha”**     Luke 10:38-42

24th    **“Praying”**     Luke 11:1-13

## ***Future Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date***

- August 7 10:30 Ecumenical Worship at Minnehaha Falls Park
- Sept. 4 10:00 One Service (Labor Day Weekend)
- Sept. 11 10:00 One service outside; Welcome Sunday
- Oct. 15 Harvest Dinner



*Children's Sunday*



## *Minnehaha Youth Activities for the Summer:*

June 5th - Graduation Sunday We are going to spend the morning celebrating with our high school graduates! They will be announced and recognized during worship at 10:00am, (there is only one Worship service this morning) and then celebrating with a cake reception afterwards at 11:00am. Please invite Family and Friends to join us in the festivities!

June 13th-17th - Music and Drama Camp - Youth can participate as campers and be in the production, and/or come as Counselors to help! Camp is from 9am-3pm with the children and Counselors will be sticking around until 6pm to work on projects, set up for the next day, and play games together.

June 15th-17th: Vacation Bible School - Youth will be participating as Group leaders and classroom helpers. Contact Jenia or Lani if you are interested!

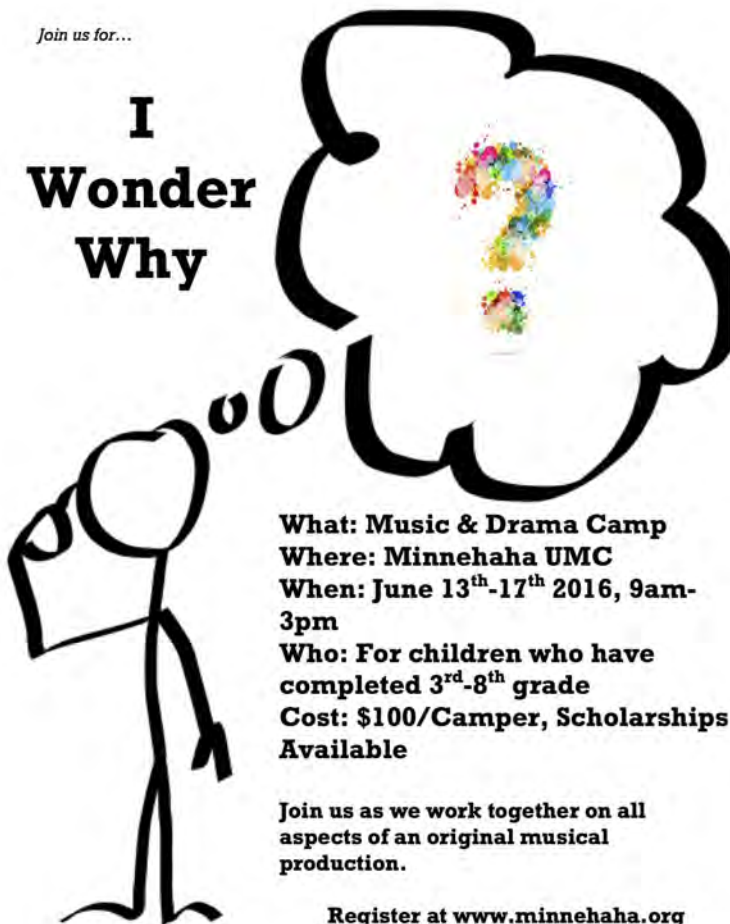
July 25th-29th: Youth Camp at Koronis Campgrounds - Youth that have finished grades 5th-9th are invited to join us for five days of fun at camp! There will be lots of swimming, laughing, canoeing, learning, campfires, amazing food and of course group games! Please contact Lani if you would like more info.

Other Summer Events: We have a few extra summer events in the making. We will announce dates once we get all the details figured out.

- Summer Lock-ins: for Youth that have finished 5th-12th grade
- Whirly ball night: for Youth that have finished 5th-12th grade
- Senior High Camping trip: for Youth that have finished 8th-12th grade

Join us for...

# I Wonder Why



**What: Music & Drama Camp**  
**Where: Minnehaha UMC**  
**When: June 13<sup>th</sup>-17<sup>th</sup> 2016, 9am-3pm**  
**Who: For children who have completed 3<sup>rd</sup>-8<sup>th</sup> grade**  
**Cost: \$100/Camper, Scholarships Available**

Join us as we work together on all aspects of an original musical production.

Register at [www.minnehaha.org](http://www.minnehaha.org)



**What: Vacation Bible School**  
**Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church**  
**When: Wednesday, June 15<sup>th</sup>-Friday, June 17<sup>th</sup>, 9-11:30 am (Extended Care available)**  
**Who: Children - age 3 (as of June 1<sup>st</sup>) through 4<sup>th</sup> grade (completed June 2016)**  
**Cost: \$25/child or \$40/family, Scholarships Available**

Students will make their own art projects at the Craft Hut, sing new music at Tidal Tunes, explore science activities at Discovery Dunes, participate in recreational activities at the Recreation Station, and enjoy tasty snacks at the Shack Snacks. Along the way, the students will consider how God's amazing love works in our lives!

Register at [www.minnehaha.org](http://www.minnehaha.org)



## Children's Ministries

We noticed driving to school the other day that the spring green color is gone - the deeper bright green of summer is here. There's other signs as well: flowers blooming, kids in lakes, long lines for ice cream, baseball games, and all the end-of-the-year activities at school. Throughout the course of this year, we've enjoyed stepping into the story with the children of Minnehaha. From choose your own adventure days, to the winter retreat and Children's musical, from sport night in the gym to comic book creations - children have had opportunities to try out new things, connect with each other, and to encounter God's love.

With the wrapping of the program year - we put the finishing touches on summer camps (information below), and start thinking about next year's programming. If you have any reflections you'd like to share in helping us make plans for the new year - please be sure to contact Jenia Strom ([education@minnehaha.org](mailto:education@minnehaha.org)).

In the meanwhile, we hope you enjoy all that summer has to offer, and thank you for all that you do to make Minnehaha a great place for kids!

It's not too late to sign up for our summer camps. Go to [www.minnehaha.org](http://www.minnehaha.org) or to the Tiki Hut in the narthex for more information/forms, etc.

For preschoolers through fourth graders, we've got Vacation Bible School running Wednesday, June 15th through Friday, June 17th. This year's theme is "Surf Shack: Catch the Wave of God's Amazing Love." We'll meet for three mornings, and enjoy music, games, crafts, science, and snacks together.

For third through eighth graders, we've got Music and Drama camp running Monday, June 13th through Friday, June 17th. Throughout the course of the week, campers will work together on all aspects of putting on an original play - culminating in the performance of the play on the evening of Friday, June 17th. This year's show will focus on the variety of stories that different cultures have to explain our origins.

Happy May to you all,  
Jenia Strom  
Director of Children and Family Ministries



### Minnehaha Playdate

For Children 5 & Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

at  
Minnehaha United Methodist Church



## *Highlights from the May 10, 2016 Church Council Meeting*

**FOOD SHELF NEEDS YOUR HELP:** The Minnehaha Food Shelf is asking for donations of food and money over the next few months. Right now the money available to purchase food from Second Harvest is low. So anything you can do to help will be appreciated. The Food Shelf will plan a campaign at their next meeting. FYI: The Food Shelf provides food for between 700 and 800 people per month in our community. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

**CHURCH FINANCES LOOK GOOD:** Right now our finances—both revenues and expenses—are on track with our budget. All bills have been paid, including apportionments, through April 30, 2016. The mortgage (capital campaign) fund has sufficient money available to pay for the oil tank removal this summer. And plans are in place to pre-pay as much of the building loan as is prudent, in order to shorten the term of our 15-year loan. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer; Sue Claude, Finance Chair)

**FIRE DRILL MOVED TO JUNE 12:** The annual fire drill has been rescheduled to June 12 at the end of the first worship service. When the alarm sounds, everyone is advised to calmly exit the building, go to the Safe Zone (on the south lawn by the raised bed gardens) and wait for the All Clear signal. During last year's drill, 124 people were evacuated in fewer than five minutes. (Gene Thompson, Building & Grounds; Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

**KIDS' COMIC BOOK PROJECT:** Comic book artist Kevin Kelly has been working with our children to create a comic book. The plan is to have the book finished in time for Children's Sunday on May 22, so ask to see a copy if you haven't already. (Jenia Strom, Coordinator of Children's Ministries)

**MINNEHAHA PLAYDATES MOVE OUTDOORS:** The weekly playgroup at Minnehaha will be moving outdoors to meet at various parks during the summer. Children – ages five and under – and their caregivers meet on Thursday mornings from 9:00 - 11:00 a.m. Stay tuned for more details. (Jenia Strom, Coordinator of Children's Ministries)

**TAIZÉ WORSHIP SERVICE TO BEGIN AGAIN IN THE FALL:** Our monthly Taizé worship service will take the summer off. (May 13 was the last service of the spring.) Make plans to attend this service of music and meditation when it starts up again in the fall. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

**NEXT MEETING JUNE 14 AT 6:30 PM:** The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for JUNE 14 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.  
—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

## *Free Concert*

All are invited to a free concert at Como Park Pavilion on Sunday, June 5 at 3:00 p.m. The Queer Music Consortium gathers once a year for a combined concert. You'll hear music from the Twin Cities Gay Men's Chorus, Calliope Women's Chorus, One Voice Mixed Chorus, Minnesota Freedom Band, and the Minnesota Philharmonic Orchestra. They will each do a few pieces, and there will be one joint piece (truly, it's worth it just to watch how they try to get a band, a symphony and 3 choirs onto that stage!). The concert is a fun event, and the pavilion is covered, so no need to worry if the weather looks less than sunny.

If you are interested in going, please let Rene Cronquist or Becky know and we can suggest connections for potential car-pooling (parking is usually tight) as well as a meeting place so our group can sit together.

## *Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square*

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a conversation/study on some topic of interest. Anyone is welcome to come. In June and July, we will be gathering on June 9 and July 14.

## *A Fun Way to Fundraise at Minnehaha*

**Mingle** [ming-guh l] **verb**, mingled, mingling. *To mix or combine; put together in a mixture; blend; to unite, join, or conjoin.*

We think of the word **mingle** as a verb – something you do – to visit, to talk-with, to move amongst a group of people. Now, we want you to think of the word **mingle** as a Noun – a thing or an event! In fact the Finance Committee is coining the term **Minnehaha Mingle** as a special fundraising event put on by any of you at Minnehaha. We want our fundraising to be creative, fun and something new. Here's an example:

- ♦ Saturday, June 18<sup>th</sup> Peter & Sue Johnson are hosting a **Mingle** that is a BBQ event at their home. They will provide the venue, the food and refreshments. Those who would like to participate will pay \$30 per person, or \$50 per couple to attend, but payment is made to Minnehaha – there are still spots open – please see Sue, Peter or Annette on Sunday! Minnehaha benefits in many ways, not just financially:
  - Up to 20 people will be participating in this gathering – Any and all are welcome
  - These 20 people will **mingle** and get to know one another – potentially meet someone new
  - The “mingling” effect will give those participating, a chance to broaden their circle of friends and acquaintances, enjoy a casual evening at someone's home, and hopefully spark ideas about what kind of **Minnehaha Mingle** they would like to host

Here are some things to consider when you plan a **Mingle**

- ♦ It doesn't have to be as large as 20 people, or it can be more or less
- ♦ It doesn't have to be a dinner it can be as simple as viewing a video at church – for fun or to engage in discussion afterwards
- ♦ Some other **Mingle** events being talked about are
  - A Thai food dinner
  - Going to a play – possibly starring one of our in-house actors  
(Angie Timberman-Albright, Julie Cook, Jefferson Slinkard, just to name a few)
  - A crafting event – card-making, scrapbooking, knitting/crocheting
  - A chance to drive a Mazda Miata convertible for a week

Any and all ideas are welcome! If you would like to plan and host an event, please contact Annette Meier, Fundraising Coordinator at (612) 597-1778 or [salmeier@hotmail.com](mailto:salmeier@hotmail.com). She is here to help you coordinate what you need help with, including **Mingle** ideas, publicity, using the church facility, pricing, volunteer help, etc. There is such great creativity in our Minnehaha community – let's all use that talent and energy to have some fun while we support our church.

## *Office Closed*

Annual Conference, the annual gathering of the United Methodist Church in Minnesota, meets in St. Cloud the week of June 20. In addition, Heather, our office administrator, has a theater show out of state that week. Numerous other staff also have commitments that week that take them out of the office, so we are closing the office the week of June 20. There will be an outgoing message of our phones letting people know that the office is closed, and Becky will be available by cell phone during that week.

## *Pride Parade*

June is the month for celebrating GLBT Pride all over the nation, and the parade and festival in the Twin Cities will be Saturday and Sunday, June 25-26. The Festival is held at Loring Park, and you can go there anytime from 10-10 on Saturday or 10-6 on Sunday. You'll find concerts, food vendors, booths for companies and organizations, and so much more. Their webpage, [TCPride.org](http://TCPride.org) will give you all the information. If you go, look for the Reconciling Congregations booth. The Parade is on Sunday and kicks off at 11:00 a.m. The United Methodist Reconciling Congregations have a marching contingent as well as a float, and members of reconciling congregations are welcome to join in however they can. The units line up on 3<sup>rd</sup> Street, facing Hennepin Ave. and the parade goes down Hennepin until it reaches Loring Park. You can find our unit number (which will aid in finding our group more quickly) on the pride web page a couple days prior to the parade. We recommend wearing your Minnehaha T-shirts (if you have one) and bringing some Hershey's kisses to hand out to people along the parade route. If you are planning on being part of the parade, let Becky know so she can give you any last minute changes or information.

## *General Conference*

General Conference is the decision-making body of the United Methodist Church, and it gathers every 4 years with delegates from around the world who consider, debate, and vote on our rules and teachings for the next 4 years. General Conference for 2016 came to an end in mid-May. You might be wondering what happened at that conference, and the answer varies based on your perspective. If you look through the lens of progressives vs. conservatives, then this General Conference definitely favored the conservatives. We did not divest from fossil fuels, we did not divest from corporations that help with the creation of illegal settlements in Palestine, and we did sever our ties with the Religious Coalition for Reproductive Choice. Our Social Principles (teachings) remain pro-choice, but only just barely. The people elected to the University Senate (which determines which seminaries are acceptable for future clergy to attend) and to the Judicial Council (our version of the Supreme Court) were all of the conservative slate.

If you look through the lens of unity vs. separation, then unity won the day. Despite some very serious rumors about the potential for a split, our bishops opted for unity. The body asked them to make a recommendation about how we might continue to stay together, and the end result was that the Council of Bishops is empowered to create a commission to look at all of the teachings and rules in our Discipline related to human sexuality and for that commission to come up with proposed language that would be consistent throughout the Discipline, would follow the first of our General Rules (which is Do No Harm), and would take into consideration differing contexts around the world. In addition, they may consider not enforcing rules around gay and lesbian clergy and the performing of same-sex weddings so that there would be no trials during the time the commission meets. The Council of Bishops has not agreed to do that last piece yet, but it is an option that might be implemented between now and the next General Conference (which will be in 2020). In keeping with the spirit of unity, 56 petitions related to human sexuality were then removed from the docket and we did not formally debate the issue that is most definitely the most divisive in our denomination as this time. Even though no petitions were debated, the topic was certainly discussed in small groups, at mealtimes, and over breaks. The day before General Conference started, 111 clergy signed a statement coming out as gay or lesbian, even though by signing the petition, they might be subject to a trial. The weekend before that, a gay pastor openly married his partner of 28 years, and then during the first week of conference, announced that he is running for bishop. Bishops are elected at regional gatherings, which take place this July. This particular candidate is in our region, so stay tuned for more on that front!

If you look at General Conference through the lens of what impact this has on the average person in the pew, the answer is not much. We didn't change our teachings in any major ways, we didn't create term limits for bishops. The budget passed was a little higher than the one passed in 2012, which trickles down eventually into our apportionments, but by the time that amount is trickled throughout the United States, it is a very small number. We did not restructure the general church, and we didn't significantly change the way we ordain or appoint clergy. The upshot is that if you weren't reading this article, you might not notice that General Conference had even met. But, the mood at General Conference, which has been getting more tense each gathering, was definitely more tense than 4 years ago. The conversation about splitting in some way as a denomination was more real than it has ever been. Human sexuality has become a line drawn in the sand for both progressives and conservatives, and compromise positions are becoming harder and harder to come by. The vote to ask the Council of Bishops for a proposal had high approval. But the vote to actually approve their proposal only passed on a vote of 428 to 405. The results of this commission and their recommendation, whether to the 2020 General Conference or to a special General Conference called before then will be watched by the whole world. Until then, though, we are still the United Methodist Church.

## *Extra Outdoor Worship Opportunity*

One of our members, Ashley Smit, was active in her youth group in Wichita, KS. That youth group will be staying at Minnehaha June 14<sup>th</sup> and June 15<sup>th</sup>. Part of their trip is that they provide a worship service that involves music, drama, scripture and skits. We are all invited to have dinner with them (we'll be grilling outside) on Tuesday, June 14, at 5:00. Worship outside will be at 6:00. Please join us for either or both!

## Strengthening Our Core

Thanks to everyone for your support as we continue to strengthen our core! Our vote on the recommendations of the Healthy Church Initiative passed on May 15 with 90% of those present voting to move forward. You'll be hearing more in the days, weeks, months, and years to come as we begin to work out how to implement the recommendations and become even more vital as a congregation within our community.



## Love Offering

Each year, congregations in the Minnesota Annual Conference of the United Methodist Church take a Love Offering for missions. The offering is brought to annual conference session – a gathering of United Methodist clergy and laity from across the state (Becky Sechrist and Valerie Mayer will represent Minnehaha at this gathering). Last year, donations exceeded \$100,000. The theme of this year's session is "Living Generously: Unleashing God's Gift," and funds from this year's Love Offering will go to four projects. 40% will go to the Minnesota Council of Churches Refugee Services which helps refugees who come to Minnesota with employment, education, and case management. 10% will go towards the costs of shipping the Health Kits each congregation is encouraged to collect when the time comes to send them to those in need. 40% will go to International Child Care in the Dominican Republic, which has developed grassroots, community-based health and rehabilitation programs so that parents are able to care for their children with physical or mental disabilities. The remaining 10% will go towards scholarships for first-time participants going on mission projects through the United Methodist Volunteers in Mission.

You can contribute to the Love Offering through Sunday, June 19. Just indicate "Love Offering" on your check, and we'll bring a check for the total amount to Annual Conference.

### 2016 Minnehaha Garden Parties

#### Tuesday, 14<sup>th</sup> June – Summer Fun Kick-off!

5:00pm – Dinner and Garden Party

The youth will get the grills going – bring your own meat to grill and a dish to share. For this dinner, we are hosting 40 people – youth and their chaperones from West Height UMC in Wichita Kansas – *So feel free to be generous with your sides!*

6:00pm – Outdoor Worship led by the Youth Caravan Choir from West Heights UMC



#### Sunday, 10<sup>th</sup> July – Cowboy Church & Ranch Party

For our second service at 10:30am: Find your boots, hats, and bandanas, and join us for Cowboy Church

At 11:30am: Join us for a cowboy lunch (free will donations), horseshoes and other games, and work in the garden

#### Wednesday, 24<sup>th</sup> August – Farewell to Summer & Cold Salad Potluck

5:30pm: Bring your favorite cold salad to share, and come for dinner, lawn games, and time in the garden as we say farewell to summer.



United  
Methodist  
Women

## *United Methodist Women*

UMW news We all enjoyed the Spring Salad Luncheon and learned a lot from Diane Enge, walking out with beautiful bouquets! And the annual hanging and potted plant sale went very well also, helping us toward completing our budget and making our backyards lovely. There will be two final events this spring, both related to food. We also had the opportunity to serve at Simpson Shelter on May 23, a great meal of pulled beef sandwiches with cheesy potatoes. The daytime circles will be meeting at Wabun Park at 11:30 on June 8 for shared picnic lunch and the evening circles will be getting in line for dinner the next evening at Sea Salt Restaurant at Minnehaha Park at 6:30, on June 9. Not in a circle? You are invited and welcome to join either group to get to know the UMW women of Minnehaha UMC. Just come. BYO lunch to Wabun!

If you have a student who will be in need of scholarship help for a coming year of college, the UMW offers scholarships to those who give us a written request; our scholarship contact is Sarah Hicks or you can leave it in our mailbox in the office.

## *IAM20® MEDITATION REFRESHER CLASS*

Is it hard to meditate regularly? Would you like support in integrating **IAM20** into your life on a regular basis? Would you like to review the steps of **IAM20**? Would you like to experience the power of meditating with a group?

If so, please join us at this refresher class for those who have completed the 3 hour **IAM20** class. We will review steps, answer questions, and meditate as a group.

**When:** June 18<sup>th</sup>, 1:45 pm to around 4 pm—we'll end earlier if we are done.

**Where:** Minnehaha United Methodist Church, 3701 E 50<sup>th</sup> Street, MPLS 55417.

**Register at:** [meditationiam@gmail.com](mailto:meditationiam@gmail.com), or call Arun Hejmadi at 719-963-5244

**Cost:** No charge. Donation requested to cover expenses, overage will be donated to Amma's charities (see [www.amma.org](http://www.amma.org) for info about charities) and Minnehaha Food Shelf.

## *IAM®20 Meditation Class: Learn an effective 20 minute meditation technique for busy people*

**IAM®20** –Integrated Amrita Meditation®—is a meditation technique created by Mata Amritanandamayi, a world famous saint from India ( [www.amma.org](http://www.amma.org) for more info on her). In 20 minutes per day, **IAM®20** promotes integration of body, mind, and spirit. Practitioners report feeling more relaxed and centered. Regular practice of **IAM®** lowers stress hormone (adrenaline and cortisol) levels, according to an 8 month follow up study. **IAM®20** is a secular meditation which integrates easily into any spiritual or health support practice regimen. For more info about **IAM®**, go to [www.integratedmeditation.org](http://www.integratedmeditation.org).

**When:** Saturday, July 16, 2016, from 12:45 to 4 pm.

**Where:** Minnehaha United Methodist Church, 3701 E 50<sup>th</sup> Street, MPLS 55417

**REGISTER EARLY, BRING A FRIEND:** Please send name, phone number and email address to [meditationiam@gmail.com](mailto:meditationiam@gmail.com) or call Arun Hejmadi 719-963-5244.

**Cost:** No charge. Donation requested to cover expenses, overage will be donated to Amma's charities (see [www.amma.org](http://www.amma.org) for info about charities) and Minnehaha Food Shelf.

Note  
from the  
pastor



### Community in Cleaning

After my mother's death in April, my brother and I chose to clean out her house and sell it. Although my mother was very organized, and had already done a lot of tossing, this was still a monumental task. We reached out to some friends for help, and over the course of two weekends worked to get the house ready to put on the market. Those who participated became a small community over those two weekends, and it kind of re-



minded me of a church community. First, we had to agree on a common goal. Was it to make sure as much went into recycling as possible and as little into trash? Was it to make sure that anything usable got into the hands of someone who could use it? Was it to sell as much as possible, making as much money as we could? My brother and I agreed that those might all be values, but our number one goal was to get everything out of the house that needed to get out of the house in order for us to be able to clean it and have it ready to sell by the end of the second weekend. Yes, recycling was important. But once the recycling bin was full (which took about ½ a day), that value fell behind our agreed-upon goal. Giving things away was also important, but it became clear that we'd need a dumpster and not just more trips to Goodwill if we were to get done in time. And, Goodwill will only accept certain things, so the time it would take to post on free give away websites would be more time consuming than ordering the dumpster. Some things we are selling, but only high-ticket items since we decided that making money was our lowest priority. With the main goal clear, everyone set out to a task. Some people wanted to be told where to work next, others took initiative and picked a chore that made sense to them. Did that mean that some initiatives (like choosing to spackle holes in the wall) lead to unanticipated tasks (like painting an entire wall because we didn't have the right color paint to do touch up painting)? Sure. And, did some things posted for sale end up in Goodwill by mistake? Yup. But we knew it wasn't intentional, and everyone was trying to do their best. Not everyone could be there the whole time, so the composition of workers changed regularly, but whoever was there brought their own gifts and talents and blended them with others. And, people watched out for each other. The person wearing a back brace was regularly told to move away from the heavy furniture so others could lift and move it. The person recently out of surgery was told to sit down and rest for a bit. When talkative friends and neighbors stopped by needing to share an important story or some pictures with my brother and I, others would keep an eye on us, and after an appropriate amount of time, would come out and rescue us, asking us to come back in for a task or an opinion so that we could graciously make an exit and get back to accomplishing the goal.

Not everyone got introduced to one another properly, and people had to make their own introductions as they cleaned out a room together or lifted a piece of furniture together. But, we ate a meal together every day, taking the time to talk, make jokes, and reminisce. The help was invaluable, and someone who came just for a few hours ended up finding the nativity set my mother had set up since we were children. It wasn't with the Christmas things, and so we were at a loss as to its location. It was found behind some books in a bookcase. Another person dedicated herself to dealing with all the sewing things in my mom's sewing room, and after hours of sorting through fabric and projects, she also located the ashes of my grandmother. They were clearly labeled, and we all got a good laugh at Grandma's unexpected temporary resting place. It was community at its best. People did what they could when they could. They agreed to the goal my brother and I set, even if it was different than the one they would have chosen. Each brought their best selves to the task. Everyone was patient with one another. People took breaks, went to other events (like birthday parties and painting classes and church) as they needed to, but everyone was a part of that community. And, after two weekends, we reached our goal. Now, I know that church life isn't quite that easy, but it still reminded me that community is one of the things church does best. We gather people in from wherever they are. We accept each one's gifts and talents. We affirm that sometimes other things are also important (like birthday parties and painting classes), and we sit down to meals together. We laugh, we reminisce. We also dream about the future, we pray, we make sure we are going outside of the church walls. And, we look at our goals and values. We evaluate how we are doing, and, periodically, assess whether our goals and values are still appropriate and what we might be doing differently. Community can be a powerful thing, as those two weekends can attest to. Just imagine what we can all do together when we have a lot longer than two weekends to make a difference in the world. Or, as the mission of the United Methodist Church says, when we are making disciples of Jesus Christ for the transformation of the world.

In joy, Becky



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6+7/16

A decorative banner with a wavy, scalloped edge is positioned at the top of the page. It features a series of colorful triangles in shades of red, orange, yellow, and blue, arranged in a repeating pattern along the top edge.

# Rummage Sale

## Saturday, June 18, 2016

### 8:00am-4:00pm!

**Minnehaha UMC is joining in with NENA  
(Nokomis East Neighborhood Association)  
on their Annual Garage Sale Day!**

To make this a successful fundraiser for Minnehaha, we need your help - :

- **Volunteers -**
  - Week of June 13<sup>th</sup> - afternoons & evenings
  - Saturday, June 18<sup>th</sup> - 3 hour shifts starting at 6:00am
- **Items to Sell**
  - **Clothing/Shoes** - Gently used and clean
  - **Household items** - dishes, glassware, linens (gently used & clean), décor - picture frames, knick-knacks, etc.
  - **Sporting Equipment**
  - **Books**

Questions? Please contact Jenny Ammerman (651) 683-0807 /  
Kate Stower (612) 280-5161 / Annette Meier (612) 597-1778